Demo Version of the Second-Round Tasks

Education and Psychology: Second-Round Sample Tasks for the Open Doors Master's and Doctoral Tracks

This sample test includes 46 tasks: 25 basic-level test tasks with one correct answer, 15 intermediate-level tasks with several correct answers or a model answer, 3 advanced-level tasks requiring a detailed answer, and 3 oral-response tasks. For tasks requiring a detailed answer and for oral-response tasks, assessment criteria and model answers are provided.

Task 1

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

The process of purposive transmission and acquisition of knowledge, skills, and abilities is termed…

a) upbringing

b) teaching

c) learning

d) socialization

Answer: b

Task 2

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

The mechanism of upbringing whereby a child unconsciously copies the behaviour of a significant adult is

a) imitation

b) reflection

c) exteriorisation

d) conformity

Answer: a

Task 3

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

The leadership style in which the teacher grants pupils complete freedom of action is called…

a) authoritarian style

b) democratic style

c) permissive style

d) situational style

Answer: c

Task 4

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

An intrinsic motive for learning is

a) parental praise

b) interest in the subject content itself

c) the desire to avoid a poor mark

d) receiving a gift for achievement

Answer: b

Task 5

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

Which of the following refers to primary prevention?

a) Treatment of anxiety disorder

b) Educational program about stress

c) Psychotherapy after trauma

Answer: b

Task 6

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

Which type of prevention involves working with risk groups?

a) Primary

b) Secondary

c) Tertiary

Answer: b

Task 7

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology

According to B. Skinner, academic behaviour is shaped through…

a) free choice

b) reinforcement of desired responses

c) punishment of all errors

d) insightful revelation

Answer: b

Task 8

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology

A condition for effective upbringing influence (according to A. S. Makarenko) is…

a) unity of demands and respect for the individual

b) exclusively lenient treatment

c) a complete absence of demands

d) reliance solely on punishment

Answer: a

Task 9

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology

Pedagogical tact is…

a) the ability to avoid conflict at any cost

b) the form of implementation of pedagogical morality in the teacher's activities

c) a permissive attitude

d) consistently raising one's voice

Answer: b

Task 10

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology

Achievement motivation is characterised by…

a) choosing extremely easy or extremely difficult tasks

b) complete withdrawal from activity

c) choosing moderately challenging tasks and demonstrating persistence

d) dependence on the opinions of others.

Answer: c

Task 11

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology

What indicators did C. Spearman identify to characterize general intelligence?

a) Level of mental energy, speed of switching between activities, speed of mental energy recovery

b) Operations, content, results

c) Analytical aspect, creative aspect, practical aspect

d) Operations of grouping objects into classes and classes among themselves, operations of combining asymmetric relations, substitution operations that combine various simple classes into a composite class obtained through prior grouping

Answer: a

Task 12

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology

Which temperament type corresponds to the athletic constitutional type in E. Kretschmer's theory?

a) Cyclothymic

b) Ixothymic

c) Schizothymic

d) Sanguine

Answer: b

Task 13

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, educational

The process of transforming external, object-based actions into an internal mental plane is termed…

a) exteriorisation

b) interiorisation

c) automatisation

d) generalisation

Answer: b

Task 14

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, educational

Empathy as a core professional attribute of an educator refers to…

a) the ability to assign grades

b) strictness and demandingness

c) the capacity to understand another's emotional state

d) oratorical skill

Answer: c

Task 15

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, educational

The teacher's ability to regulate their own emotional state during professional practice is termed:

a) pedagogical optimism

b) pedagogical reflection

c) pedagogical tact

d) emotional self-regulation

Answer: d

Task 16

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, educational

The undermining of intrinsic motivation through the introduction of an external reward is termed…

a) the overjustification effect

b) positive transfer

c) motivation enhancement

d) interference

Answer: a

Task 17

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, educational

D. B. Elkonin asserted that play is a symbolico-modeling type of activity in which:

a) children assimilate experiences of human activity

b) children interact with peers in a learning context

c) the process of self-determination, value-orientation activity, and development of independence occurs

d) the process of self-realization through creative activity takes place

Answer: a

Task 18

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Education, special

What does a pupil's inability to transfer a learned method of action to a novel task indicates?

a) high motivation

b) creative thinking

c) low learning ability

d) developed reflection

Answer: c

Task 19

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Education, special

The upbringing principle of 'building on the positive in the individual' means…

a) ignoring shortcomings

b) developing the pupil's strengths to overcome their weaknesses

c) using only praise without critique

d) comparing the pupil to an ideal student

Answer: b

Task 20

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Education, special

A teacher's innovative activity is focused on

a) repeating already established methods

b) rejecting any changes

c) implementing new, effective means of teaching and upbringing

d) new technical equipment provision

Answer: c

Task 21

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, social

What does the effect of self-fulfilling prophecy in social perception mean?

a) One person's expectations of another affect the behavior of the expectant, but not the behavior of the target.

b) The initial misconception about another person does not change under the influence of facts and remains stable.

c) The expectations of the perceiving individual (for example, that the other person is hostile or incompetent) unknowingly change his behavior towards the target, which provokes the target to behave in accordance with these expectations, thereby confirming the initial assumption.

d) The perceiver always internalizes the majority opinion of the other person under pressure from the group

Answer: c

Task 22

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, social

Within the framework of the psychoanalytic tradition, T. Adorno and co-authors (Adorno, Frenkel-Brunswik, Levinson & Sanford, 1950) introduced the concept of an authoritarian personality to explain prejudice. Which of the listed characteristics is central to an authoritarian personality according to this approach?

a) High level of creativity and tolerance to uncertainty

b) Tendency to reflection and critical revision of group norms

c) Strong commitment to equality and social justice

d) Rigidity, conventionalism, submission to authority, aggression towards outgroups

Answer: d

Task 23

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, social

In social psychology, the principle of reciprocity in the context of interpersonal attraction means that:

a) people like those who have complementary traits, for example, a dominant likes a subordinate.

b) a positive attitude from another person (sympathy, compliments, help) is highly likely to elicit sympathy in return, and vice versa.

c) a partner's attractiveness increases when opportunities for interaction are perceived as limited (the scarcity effect)

d) people tend to idealize those who are unavailable or reject them (the Romeo and Juliet effect)

Answer: b

Task 24

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, social

In the classic experiment by S. Asch (1951) with an estimate of the length of the lines, the subjects publicly gave a deliberately incorrect answer, agreeing with the unanimous opinion of the dummy majority. However, with an anonymously written response (without the presence of a group), the level of conformity decreased sharply. What type of social influence was predominant in the public context of Asha's experiment?

a) Informational influence (striving for accuracy when the situation is uncertain)

b) Normative influence (striving to meet the group's expectations, avoid disapproval, and maintain membership)

c) Idiosyncratic credit (accumulation of the right to deviate from the norm)

d) The influence of a minority (a consistent minority that causes a revision of the position)

Answer: b

Task 25

Basic level (maximum 1 point)

Field of science: Psychology, social

What term describes the process by which emotions and behavior spread in a group?

a) Social optimization

b) Emotional contagion

c) Group dynamics

d) Social learning

Answer: b

Task 26

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

Select all correct statements about cognitive-behavioral therapy (CBT):

a) It addresses automatic thoughts.

b) It is based on dream analysis

c) It teaches new behavioral strategies

d) It uses free associations

e) It often includes homework assignments

Answer: a, c, e

Task 27

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

Establish a correspondence between the primary type of prevention and its examples:

a) Stress-resilience training at school

b) Developing healthy habits

c) Burnout risk screening among doctors

d) Rehabilitation after a depressive episode

Answer: a, b

Task 28

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, applied

Which of the following are characteristics of deviant behavior? Select all that apply.

a) deviation from social norm

b) stability

c) potential destructiveness

d) social harm

e) variety of forms

Answer: a, c, d

Task 29

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology

What are the indicators of Learning Activity Formation (G. Vergeles). Select all that apply.

a) goal-striving

b) goal-directedness

c) intellectual development

d) cognitive flexibility

e) self-directedness

f) stability

Answer: a, e, f

Task 30

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology

Which of the following conditions promote the internalization of extrinsic motivation? Select all that apply.

a) recognition of personal relevance

b) conditions for the Internalization of extrinsic motivation

c) increased coercive pressure and punitive measures

d) autonomy support

e) disregard for intrinsic impulses

f) teacher influence

Answer: a, b, d

Task 31

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology

An educational method based on the repeated practice of behaviors with the aim of forming stable habits is called…

Answer: exercise

Task 32

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology

A teacher's ability to objectively analyze their professional actions, evaluate their effectiveness, and plan adjustments is called…

Answer: educational reflection

Task 33

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, educational

Which of the following are principles of upbringing? Select all that apply.

a) unification principle

b) principle of the open-ended nature of upbringing

c) principle of historicism

d) principle of personalization

e) principle of uniqueness

f) developmentally appropriate practice

Answer: b, d, f

Task 34

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, educational

Which of the following are aspects of pedagogical communication? Select all that apply.

a) Professional communication between the teacher and students in class and beyond

b) Professional rivalry between educators

c) Creating a psychological climate for educational activity and relationships between the educator and students, as well as within the student collective.

d) Striving for self-realization through creative activities

e) The need for self-determination and the development of independence

Answer: a, c

Task 35

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, educational

What term describes motivation related to interest in the process of cognitive activity?

Answer: Internal motivation

Task 36

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Education, special

Which of the following are functions of upbringing? Select all that apply.

a) socialization function

b) individualization

c) regulatory function

d) protective function

e) humanistic function

f) corrective function

Answer: a, b, e

Task 37

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Education, special

Which of the following are key areas of speech therapy intervention for general speech underdevelopment? Select all that apply.

a) developing reading skills

b) forming appropriate articulatory positions

c) developing writing skills

d) forming phonemic hearing and phonemic representations

Answer: b, d

Task 38

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, social

What are the main factors of group dynamics? Select all that apply.

a) Social identity

b) The influence of leaders

c) Conflict between groups

d) Individual achievements

e) Group size

Answer: a, b, e

Task 39

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, social

What are the main psychological mechanisms of group pressure? Select all that apply.

a) Social comparison

b) Fear of exclusion

c) General intention

d) Emotional manipulation

e) Conformism

Answer: a, b, e

Task 40

Intermediate level (maximum 3 points)

Field of science: Psychology, social

What are "primary impressions" in social psychology? Select all that apply.

a) First thoughts about a person based on her / his appearance

b) An assessment made as a result of long communication

c) The impact of stereotypes and bias

d) The basis for the formation of subsequent judgments

e) Short-term emotions when meeting

Answer: a, c, d

Task 41

Advanced level (maximum 10 points)

Field of science: Psychology

List and briefly characterize the types of reflection in the processes of pedagogical communication (according to S.V. Kondratieva and B.P. Kovalev)

Answer: 1. Communicative reflection refers to the subject's awareness of how they are perceived, evaluated, and treated by others ("the self as seen through others' eyes").
2. Socio-perceptual reflection involves the teacher's re-examination and critical reassessment of their own

beliefs, impressions, and judgments about students that have formed during the course of interpersonal interaction.
3. Personal (intrapersonal) reflection denotes the process of introspective analysis of one's own consciousness, motives, and actions, serving as a mechanism for self-knowledge and self-understanding.

Assessment criteria

Criterion 1: The response enumerates the full typology of reflection — 0–3 points

Criterion 2: Brief but meaningful definitions are provided for all reflective modalities — 0–4 points

Criterion 3: The answer demonstrates how each type manifests specifically within pedagogical communication — 0–4 points

Task 42

Advanced level (maximum 10 points)

Field of science: Education, special

List the main cognitive processes in order of increasing complexity of mental representation (from sensation to thinking) and briefly describe:

- the type of reality representation characteristic of each process;
- how each successive process builds on the results of the preceding process and qualitatively transforms them into a more complex form of representation.

Answer: Sensation. Type of reflection: Direct, sensory isolation of individual stimulus properties. Serves as the primary foundation, supplying “raw” material for further reflection without semantic processing.
Perception. Type of reflection: Holistic, object-centered, and structural reflection. Transforms discrete sensations into a unified object image, extracting salient features through apperception and organizing sensory data into a coherent system.
Attention. Type of reflection: Selective orientation and concentration of mental activity on specific objects or operations. Functions as an information filter that extracts relevant data from the general sensory stream, creating the necessary conditions for deeper processing and encoding.
Memory. Type of reflection: Retrospective, temporal consolidation of experience. Preserves the outcomes of sensory and semantic reflection, ensuring continuity between past experience and the current situation, thereby making reflection cumulative.
Imagination. Type of reflection: Anticipatory, creatively transformative reflection. Recombines and modifies stored memory traces to generate novel mental models of reality that do not yet exist in actual experience, thus expanding the boundaries of reflection beyond immediate givenness.
Thinking. Type of reflection: Mediated, generalized, and rational reflection of essential connections and lawful patterns in reality. The highest form of reflection: abstracts from concrete particulars, operates with concepts, and uncovers causal relationships, transcending the limits of perceptual immediacy.

Assessment criteria

Criterion 1: Completeness and logical sequencing — 0–3 points

Criterion 2: Theoretical accuracy — 0–3 points

Criterion 3: Logical continuity of processes — 0–2 points

Criterion 4: Terminological precision — 0–2 points

Task 43

Advanced level (maximum 10 points)

Field of science: Psychology, social

In settings characterized by a rigid status hierarchy (for example, in a medical team or crew), members of a low-status group tend to demonstrate higher accuracy of social perception (recognition of emotions, attribution of intentions) in relation to high-status members vice versa. Using attribution theories (for example, the Jones and Davis model of correspondent inference, the fundamental attribution error) and the concept of metasterotypes, explain this phenomenon from an evolutionary and cognitive-motivational perspective.

Answer: The phenomenon of higher perceptual accuracy of low-status group members (Fiske, 1993; Goodwin et al., 2000) is explained by evolutionary expediency: individuals in a dependent position require increased attention to dominant signals in order to predict punishment or reward. From a cognitive-motivational perspective, high-status members tend to use stereotyping and heuristics of "cognitive stinginess" (Fiske & Taylor), which generates a fundamental attribution error: the behavior of low-status members is explained by their dispositions (laziness, incompetence), rather than situational constraints. According to the correspondent inference model, high-status employees are less likely to take into account the unique circumstances of their subordinates, since they do not expect socially desirable deviations from them.
Low-status ones, on the contrary, activate systematic processing due to motivation for control and reduction of uncertainty. They encounter metasterotypes, beliefs about how they are perceived by a high–status group. To refute a negative image (for example, "we are considered lazy"), low-status people intensively monitor the emotional and intentional signals of leaders. Evolutionarily, such hypersensitivity increases the chances of reducing the status threat and obtaining resources.

Assessment criteria

Criterion 1: Explaining asymmetry through attribution theories and evolution — 0–4 points

Criterion 2: Integration of evolutionary and motivational approaches — 0–5 points

Criterion 3: The length of the answer is not more than 2000 characters — 0–2 points

Task 44

For the oral-response section, the participant must choose one of the three tasks numbered 44, 45, and 46.

Demo Version of the Second-Round Tasks

Oral-response task (maximum 5 points)

Field of science: Psychology

Advanced-level task: 41

Case:

A history teacher actively integrates digital tools into instruction: online quizzes, class chats, and video lessons. However, he notices that some students—particularly the quieter ones—have stopped participating in discussions, and ironic or sarcastic remarks directed at him have begun to appear in the class chat.

During a faculty meeting, a colleague comments that students perceive the teacher's digital initiatives as a form of surveillance rather than as opportunities for engagement. The teacher is surprised by this reaction and asks why efforts to modernize teaching are being perceived so negatively.

Task (Oral Response):

Analyze the situation: How might a deficit in each type of reflection (communicative, socio-perceptual, personal) have contributed to the described scenario?

Propose actionable steps: Suggest one concrete strategy the teacher could implement to develop each type of reflection in the context of digital pedagogy.

Answer: 1. Communicative Reflection

• Analysis of deficit: The teacher failed to recognize how students perceive the introduction of digital tools. Rather than experiencing them as educational support, students interpret them as a form of continuous monitoring and control. This perception triggers disengagement among quieter learners and provokes a defensively ironic response within the class collective.

• Concrete strategy for development: Conduct an anonymous rapid-feedback survey or digital form with prompts such as: "Which online formats support your learning? Which cause discomfort or anxiety?" Crucially, the results must be discussed openly with the class, and guidelines for using chats and quizzes should be co-constructed with student input.

2. Socio-Perceptual Reflection

• Analysis of deficit: The teacher did not critically reassess their initial assumption that all contemporary adolescents respond uniformly positively to technology. This oversight led to neglecting individual differences in digital literacy, anxiety levels, and preferred modes of content acquisition.

• Concrete strategy for development: Maintain a brief "digital comfort observation log" to record, after each lesson, which students engage actively and which withdraw. Based on these data, offer alternative task formats (text-based, audio, visual) and flexible deadlines to accommodate diverse learning preferences.

3. Personal (Intrapersonal) Reflection

• Analysis of deficit: The teacher did not examine their own internal motives for technology integration. Behind the active use of digital tools may lie a desire to "align with current trends" or demonstrate professional expertise, rather than a genuine pedagogical rationale grounded in student needs.

• Concrete strategy for development: Regularly pose a reflective question prior to lesson planning: "Am I

selecting this digital tool primarily for teaching convenience, or for the authentic development of each learner?" Keep a concise reflective journal after lessons to document class emotional responses and personal impressions regarding technology use.
Conclusion: The described situation arose not from the digital tools themselves, but from insufficient reflective preparation for their implementation. Developing all three types of reflection enables the teacher to transform the digital environment from a source of tension into a space for dialogue and personalized learning.

Assessment criteria

Criterion 1: Subject-specific knowledge (terminology, conceptual framework, and theoretical foundations).

Criterion 2: Breadth of knowledge (relevant facts, illustrative examples, and the integration of theory and practice).

Task 45

Oral-response task (maximum 5 points)

Field of science: Education, special

Advanced-level task: 42

Case:
A student preparing for an exam repeatedly rereads his lecture notes and even highlights key terms with a marker. However, during an oral response, he is unable to present the material coherently, and his knowledge appears fragmented and disconnected. Nevertheless, he insists that he has read and remembers all the material.

Task (Oral Response):
1. Describe how the properties of mental reflection (activity and mediated character) manifest in the processes of memorization and recall.
2. Explain why mechanical repetition (without semantic processing) fails to ensure the reliable encoding of information into memory.
3. Propose a strategy, grounded in the hierarchy of cognitive processes, that would enhance memorization effectiveness.

Answer: 1. Properties of mental reflection in memorization and recall
Activity: Memorization is not a passive "recording" but a voluntary selection of essential information, establishment of logical connections, and hypothesis-testing regarding the structure of the material. Without conscious intentionality, reflection remains superficial and rapidly decays.
Mediated character: Reliable consolidation requires sign-based and conceptual scaffolds (terms, diagrams, visual models). Information is acquired not in isolation but through a system of meaningful connections, which ensures resistance to interference and displacement.
2. Why mechanical repetition fails to ensure reliable mental reflection

Engages only the perceptual-structural level of processing without semantic encoding (cf. levels-of-processing framework, Craik & Lockhart).
Absence of logical organization leads to fragmentation: during recall, there are no "semantic hooks," causing knowledge to disintegrate into isolated elements.
Natural (involuntary) memory, operating without the involvement of thinking, fails to form robust neural networks— manifesting in the phenomenon of "I know it, but cannot articulate it coherently."
3. Strategy for effective memorization (grounded in the hierarchy of cognitive processes)
Perception and Attention: Replace passive rereading with structural extraction of material (concept maps, tables, hierarchical outlines). Attention is directed toward essential relationships rather than visual formatting.
Thinking and Memory: Semantic encoding (elaborative rehearsal)—explaining terms in one's own words, classification, and linking new content to prior knowledge. This realizes the mediated character of reflection.
Metacognitive Control (function of thinking): Retrieval practice—self-testing without reference to notes, spaced repetition. This activates volitional regulation and consolidates material through purposeful search and self-correction.

Assessment criteria

Criterion 1: Subject-specific knowledge (terminology, conceptual framework, and theoretical foundations).

Criterion 2: Breadth of knowledge (relevant facts, illustrative examples, and the integration of theory and practice).

Task 46

Oral-response task (maximum 5 points)

Field of science: Psychology, social

Advanced-level task: 43

In modern social psychology, a paradox is observed: despite the abundance of information, the level of polarization of opinions in society is growing, while trust in experts is declining. Drawing on theories of causal attribution (Heider, Kelly), the concept of cognitive dissonance (Festinger), and the “hostile media” effect (Vallone, Ross, and Lepper), explain why access to a larger volume of data does not lead to a convergence of opponents’ positions, but, on the contrary, strengthens their initial attitudes (the “reverse persuasion” effect). In addition to theoretical analysis, propose an empirical research design (experimental plan) that would allow you to verify your hypothesis about the mechanisms of this process, and indicate any possible ethical limitations of the proposed design.

Answer: The paradox is that more information often deepens polarization rather than reduces it. The explanation lies not in logic, but in cognitive defences.
Key mechanisms

1. Fundamental attribution error: we explain opponents' behaviour by their personal traits («they are biased») and our own by external factors. When new data arrive, we don't revise our judgment of others; instead, we question the source.
2. Cognitive dissonance (Festinger): contradictory information produces discomfort. To reduce it, we do not change our belief, but rationalise – we find reasons to distrust the new evidence.
3. Hostile media effect: neutral content is seen as slanted against our side. Consequently, any new facts only reinforce the original attitude.

Research design may be in the form of mixed experimental design with two participant groups (e.g., supporters and sceptics of climate policies). Independent variable: type of information (unequivocal, mixed, or neutral). We measure pre- and post-exposure confidence in their position, plus perceived source credibility. Hypothesis: in the mixed-data condition, confidence will increase while source credibility will decrease – demonstrating rationalisation.

Ethics

Informed consent, the right to withdraw, and a thorough debriefing are essential – to prevent reinforcement of biases and to help participants recognise their own cognitive distortions.

Conclusion

In short, cognitive mechanisms turn information into a tool for defending identity, not for discovering truth.

Assessment criteria

Criterion 1: Subject-specific knowledge (terminology, conceptual framework, and theoretical foundations).

Criterion 2: Breadth of knowledge (relevant facts, illustrative examples, and the integration of theory and practice).